High volume nodes act as sticky prices primarily due to the principles of **auction market theory** and the psychological impact of **trapped positions**.
First, according to auction market theory, high volume zones represent areas of **"fair value" where buyers and sellers have strongly agreed** on a price 1. Because both sides are willing to trade continuously at these levels, the market naturally chops sideways and builds up volume 1. The price tends to stick in these areas because "the market consolidates where people are" 1.
Second, these high volume nodes are not just historical markers; **they are heavily loaded with trapped positions** 2. For instance, if thousands of traders buy into a high volume zone and the market subsequently sells off, all of those buyers are left trapped in negative positions, feeling uncomfortable 2.
When the price eventually returns to that high volume level, **every single one of those trapped traders is forced to make a decision** 2. They might double down, panic sell, or simply close their trade in relief to "finally breathe again" 2. Because there is such a massive concentration of traders positioned at this exact price, **this flurry of reactions is virtually guaranteed** 2. There are simply too many market participants clustered in these nodes for the price to ignore it, which creates the "sticky" gravity that holds or stalls the price 2.